

PHASE 1 SLATE (2008–2012): 8 FILMS

Status: being built. Each film gets a full Film Dossier before it's locked.

#	Title	Release date	Owner	Dossier
1	Iron Man	Friday, May 2, 2008	Marc-Anthony Bullock	 complete
2	The Incredible Hulk	Friday, June 13, 2008	Amond Baker	 pending
3	Thor	Friday, May 1, 2009	Esther Smilley 	 pending
4	Ant-Man (with the Wasp; final title set in the dossier)	Friday, November 6, 2009	Tyler Chapman  (Elxa Bullock co-lead )	 pending
5	Iron Man 2	Friday, May 7, 2010	Marc-Anthony Bullock	 pending
6	TBD			
7	TBD			
8	TBD			

FILM #1: IRON MAN (why it kicks everything off)

- **Character:** Tony Stark / Iron Man. First appearance: *Tales of Suspense* #39 (March 1963), Stan Lee, Larry Lieber, Don Heck and Jack Kirby.
- **Why Iron Man goes first, even though we own everyone:**
- **Thanos debuted in an Iron Man comic.** Jim Starlin introduced him in *Iron Man* #55 (Feb. 1973), so starting the Infinity Saga with Iron Man is comic-accurate at the very root.
- **He's the most grounded way in.** Iron Man runs on technology instead of magic, mutation or the cosmos, so a 2008 audience can believe it. Every later film makes the world a little bigger from there.
- **Tony pays for the Avengers.** On 616, Stark money builds the team and Stark's mansion becomes its home. The man who funds the Avengers should be the first one we meet.
- **S.H.I.E.L.D. fits naturally.** A defense contractor is exactly who Nick Fury would show up to see.
- **The underdog story matches the studio's.** It's a B-list hero from a studio that's never made a movie, starring an actor Hollywood wrote off. Tony, Marc-Anthony and Marvel all have something to prove.
- **Release date: Friday, May 2, 2008.** It's the first weekend of the summer season, a week ahead of *Speed Racer* (May 9) and three weeks ahead of *Indiana Jones and the Kingdom of the Crystal Skull* (May 22),

which gives it room to hold on for several weekends.

FILM #2: THE INCREDIBLE HULK

- **Character:** Bruce Banner / the Hulk. First appearance: *The Incredible Hulk #1* (May 1962), Stan Lee & Jack Kirby.
- **Why second:** he's a **founding Avenger**, and in *Avengers #1* **the Hulk is the reason the team forms** (Loki frames him). Audiences need to meet him before that. It also pairs naturally with Iron Man: both are science origins, and Tony's workshop TV already reported the gamma accident at Desert Base. It's a grounded fugitive thriller that widens the world one step.
- **Release date: Friday, June 13, 2008.** Six weeks after *Iron Man*, so Marvel has two films in theaters in one summer. It also avoids *Hancock* (July 2) and *The Dark Knight* (July 18).

FILM #3: THOR

- **Character:** Thor Odinson. First appearance: *Journey into Mystery #83* (August 1962), Stan Lee, Larry Lieber & Jack Kirby.
- **Why third:** he's a **founding Avenger**, and **Loki, the villain who brings the Avengers together** in *Avengers #1*, comes from Thor's world. After two science films, Thor opens the door to **gods, magic and the Nine Realms, and the cosmos where Thanos lives.**
- **Release date: Friday, May 1, 2009.** It opens the 2009 summer season, the same slot *Iron Man* used, and comes a week ahead of *Star Trek* (May 8).

FILM #4: ANT-MAN (with the Wasp)

- **Characters:** Dr. Hank Pym / Ant-Man, first appearing in *Tales to Astonish #27* (January 1962) and in costume in #35 (September 1962), and Janet van Dyne / the Wasp, first appearing in *Tales to Astonish #44* (June 1963). Stan Lee, Larry Lieber, H.E. Huebner & Jack Kirby.
- **Why fourth:** Ant-Man and the Wasp are **two of the five founding Avengers**, and **the Wasp names the team.** One film brings in both, as the comics did, and pays off the Pym journal from *Iron Man*. It's sci-fi adventure at impossible scale, a fresh genre after armor, monster and myth.
- **Release date: Friday, November 6, 2009.** It opens the holiday corridor with four more weeks of family audiences behind it.
-  **Casting note:** Tyler Chapman (Hank) and Eliza Bueckler (Janet) have to be unlocked before this film goes into production, which means casting in 2008.

FILM #5: IRON MAN 2

- **Character:** Tony Stark / Iron Man, the first sequel.

- **Release date: Friday, May 7, 2010.** The first Friday in May, two years after the original. It pays off the Mandarin's rings and "Next time, baby."
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Phase 1 so far: the founders come first

By *Iron Man 2*, **four of the five founding Avengers** (Iron Man, Hulk, Thor, Ant-Man) plus the Wasp have been introduced. Slots #6–8 are still open for Captain America (whom the Avengers find frozen in the ice, as in 616) and **The Avengers** (Film #8, 2012).